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Cisco TelePresence

Eskild Hansen - Head, European Design Center, Cisco Consumer Business Group speaks on design and user interface

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How do you see India's growth in terms of internet and Wi-Fi usage?

In countries like India and China, there is massive growth in the internet. Currently, China has the most internet users and India has close to one billion people, so there is a huge number of people who can use the internet.

Is Cisco planning to create the TelePresence experience for home users?

We are planning to bring it to the consumer market, but we do not have a concrete plan yet for consumers. It's the same human network, if you think about it. If you want to connect with your friends and family, it's not about looking at a computer, but it's something you want to do in your living room. So it's a natural movement process. It will be really interesting to see how we develop as a company within the next one, two to five years.

How does Cisco see itself in comparison to the other companies out there?

We have the vision to be the leading company in our category. When we go into categories, we want to be the leader, number two is not good enough. Even with our products, if you look at the reviews they get, it shows that we are moving towards that.

Other than the external design changes, was the design team responsible for the software interface design?

What we do is, we have a collaboration model. So the whole idea



about Cisco is, we have what you call Cisco 3.0, like the web 2.0 collaboration technologies, we're doing that inside of our company. We have blogs and video blogs and all kinds of internally linked things and we use these to collaborate. So, even though we didn't execute the product, it's really about how we are moving towards the same mission. Very interesting way of working.



Does the user interface support multiple languages, and is Hindi a part of that?

The routers come with software called Easy Link Advisor, which is easy for anybody to use. You just have to follow the simple step by step procedures. The software CD comes with every router and you just have to drop in the CD and the step-by-step instructions are displayed on the screen – which makes it very easy to understand. We already have support for 33 different languages like Japanese, English and Chinese. Currently there is no support for Hindi, but we are trying to localise it as much as possible

Ashok Tripathi, General Manager, Systems and Technology Division for Wipro Infotech, on eGo - Wipro's range of networks

Wipro has had a good year as far as sales are concerned. While overall share of desktops in the computer market has come down, Wipro has held its position.

How did you manage to sustain your sales when most companies have seen a decline?

We try and differentiate ourselves in terms of design, which is specially done for local needs with service, a promise of trust and wide reach. Offering on-site warranty in more than 50 cities is part of this value proposition.

Tell us more about the eGo line of laptops.

The idea was to appeal to the *confident* buyer, address the latent need to own a good looking product. Hence, we focussed on styling, aesthetics and functionality.

How has the product been received?

eGo now accounts for 33 per cent of all notebooks sold by Wipro. In fact, in the enterprise market, Wipro is the fourth largest brand of notebooks.

We believe nettops are more suitable for office users than consumers. All-in-ones are not likely to become very common and popular in the near term.

